

CYBERSECURITY BEGINNERS HANGOUT

Your Journey Into Cybersecurity Starts Here

About me.

- I'm matthew okunnowo
- Administrative supervisor
- Cyber security learner
- Passionate about helping beginners enter tech
- Learning publicly and sharing the journey

Why This Hangout?

- Tech is too expensive
- You need ~~₦~~300k–~~₦~~500k for training
- You need a computer science degree
- Cybersecurity is only for geniuses
- Do I Need to Know Coding?

What is Cybersecurity?

Cybersecurity is the practice of protecting computers, networks, application, and data from malicious attack, theft or unauthorized access.

Why cybersecurity matters ?

- Business loses millions yearly to cyberattacks,
 - Nintendo: employee data stolen through a third party vendor attackers demand \$2m for ransom
 - MGM Resorts Int'l: Cyberattack caused operational disruption and over \$100M in losses
- personal account get hacked daily,
- data breaches affect everyone
 - Examples:
 - Bank fraud
 - Phishing scams
 - Social media hacks

Common Cyber Threats

- **Phishing:** A scam where attackers pretend to be a trusted person or organization to trick you into revealing sensitive information

EXAMPLE:

- "Your bank account has been suspended. Click here to verify your account"
- A fake WhatsApp message claiming you won ₦500,000 and asking for your bank details
 - Solutions:
 - Don't click suspicious links.
 - Verify the sender.
 - Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

- **Malware :** Malicious software designed to damage, spy on, or gain unauthorized access to a device.
 - Virus, Trojan, Spyware
 - Example: You download a "free cracked software" from a random website., Your files disappear, your system becomes slow
 - Solution: Download software only from trusted sources.
- **Ransomware:** A type of malware that encrypts your files and demands payment (ransom) to unlock them.
- **Password attacks:** Attempts to steal, guess, or crack passwords to gain access to accounts.
- **Social engineering:** Manipulating people into giving away information or performing actions they shouldn't

CYBERSECURITY VS SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

- Software Engineering focuses on building applications and systems. Cybersecurity focuses on protecting those systems and the data they process.
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Software Engineer

They are responsible for:

Designing the application

Writing the code

Adding features (login, payments, chat, etc.)

Fixing bugs

Making the app work for users

Cybersecurity professional

Protecting the application from hackers

Finding security weaknesses (vulnerabilities)

Testing the system like an attacker (ethical hacking)

Securing user data (passwords, bank info, personal data)

Preventing breaches and fraud

CYBERSECURITY CAREER PATH

- **Security Analyst:** They monitor systems and look for suspicious activity- \$60,000 – \$100,000 per year
 - **SOC Analyst:** Investigate suspicious activities, Detect cyberattacks early \$65,000 – \$120,000/year
 - **Penetration Tester:** Hack systems legally, \$80,000 – \$150,000/year
 - **Digital Forensics:** Investigate cybercrimes, analyze hacked systems \$70,000 – \$130,000/year
 - **Incident Responder:** Respond when attacks occur, Remove malware, restore affected systems. \$85,000 – \$140,000/year
 - **Cloud Security Engineer:** Protect cloud data, Monitor cloud threats \$100,000 – \$170,000/year
 - **Government Risk Compliant Analyst:** Ensure security policies are followed, Conduct audits, Develop security procedures, \$70,000 – \$130,000/year
- Note: “Cybersecurity is not one job — it is a team of specialists working together to prevent, detect, and respond to cyberattacks.”

Skills every beginner should learn first

- Networking
- Cybersecurity fundamentals
- Security tools and fundamentals
- Hands on labs
- Build projects
- Apply for internships

Free resources & websites to learn from

- Youtube
- Free labs
- Ai
- Google

How to get started today

- Create a learning schedule
- Follow cybersecurity creators
- Join communities
- Practice consistently
- Don't wait until you learn everything

Questions and Answers

- Live questions and answer



To connect with me
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